



# Web3 & The Future of Money

## Stablecoins, CBDCs, and Programmable Finance

By Samuel Je Christian · Web3 Corner Date: May 7, 2026



### Money Has Always Evolved

Shells. Gold. Paper. Credit cards. Mobile payments. Crypto. Every few centuries — money changes form. Not because people want it to, but because new technology makes a better form possible. We are living through the next evolution right now. Unlike previous transitions, this one is happening in real time, publicly, on blockchains that anyone can read.



### The Problem With Money Today

The current financial system was built for a different era.

- **Outdated Infrastructure:** SWIFT was built in 1973. It takes 3-5 business days and 3-5% in fees to move money across borders.
- **Financial Exclusion:** 1.4 billion people remain unbanked because they lack the right documents or proximity to a bank.
- **High Remittance Costs:** Sending money home costs an average of 6.3% globally.

**Blockchain fixes this—not theoretically, but right now.**



### Three Futures of Money

#### 1. Stablecoins — The Dollar on the Blockchain

Stablecoins are the most immediately practical form of digital money. They are pegged 1:1 to the US dollar and transferable in seconds.

- **Scale:** \$300 billion on-chain with 242 million holders.
- **Real Use:** Western Union now runs on Solana stablecoins; DoorDash pays contractors on-chain; major sovereign wealth funds settle multi-billion dollar deals via USD1.

#### 2. CBDCs — Government Digital Currency

Central Bank Digital Currencies are government-issued digital versions of official currency.

- **The Potential:** Financial inclusion at scale and instant government payments.
- **The Concern:** Total financial surveillance. Governments could potentially freeze, expire, or restrict your money with code.
- **Status:** Over 130 countries are exploring CBDCs, with China's digital yuan already serving 260 million+ users.

### 3. Programmable Money — The Biggest Shift

This is money with conditions built into it. Smart contracts allow for:

-  **Insurance:** Claims paid instantly when flight delay data is confirmed.
-  **Streaming Salaries:** Being paid per second rather than monthly.
-  **Logistics:** Payments released automatically when delivery is confirmed on-chain.
- **Wall Street:** DTCC, which clears \$2.15 quadrillion annually, is launching a tokenized securities platform in July 2026.

### Today at Consensus 2026 (Miami)

The final day of **Consensus Miami**, the largest crypto conference in the Americas, closes with high-level sessions on:

- The future of stablecoin regulation.
- Institutional DeFi and the "plumbing" of programmable finance.
- The convergence of AI and blockchain.

With 20,000+ leaders gathered, the consensus is clear: **Money is being rebuilt on-chain, and the builders are not waiting for permission.**

### Risks and the Honest Picture

- **Stablecoin Risks:** De-pegging, issuer insolvency, or regulatory crackdowns. Not all stablecoins are equally safe.
- **CBDC Risks:** Loss of privacy and the potential political weaponization of money.
- **Programmable Finance Risks:** "Code is law," but bad code is bad law. Smart contract bugs can be catastrophic.
- **Regulatory Uncertainty:** Global frameworks like the EU's MiCA and Singapore's MAS are still evolving.

### The One-Line Summary

**The future of money is digital, programmable, and on-chain — built on stablecoins, shaped by CBDCs, and powered by smart contracts that execute automatically.**

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